

402MAN

Interactive and Transactional Models



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DLHE survey, UG UK, 2016/17
(published 2018)

Recap on previous learning:

What is meant linear communication models?

What theories can be applied to a linear communication model?

Describe the three elements of Aristotles Communication Model



Session Intent:

- Investigate both interactive and transactional models of communication
- Understand contemporary models and the use of digital platforms and communication
- Explore how technology is changing the way we communicate, work and behave.

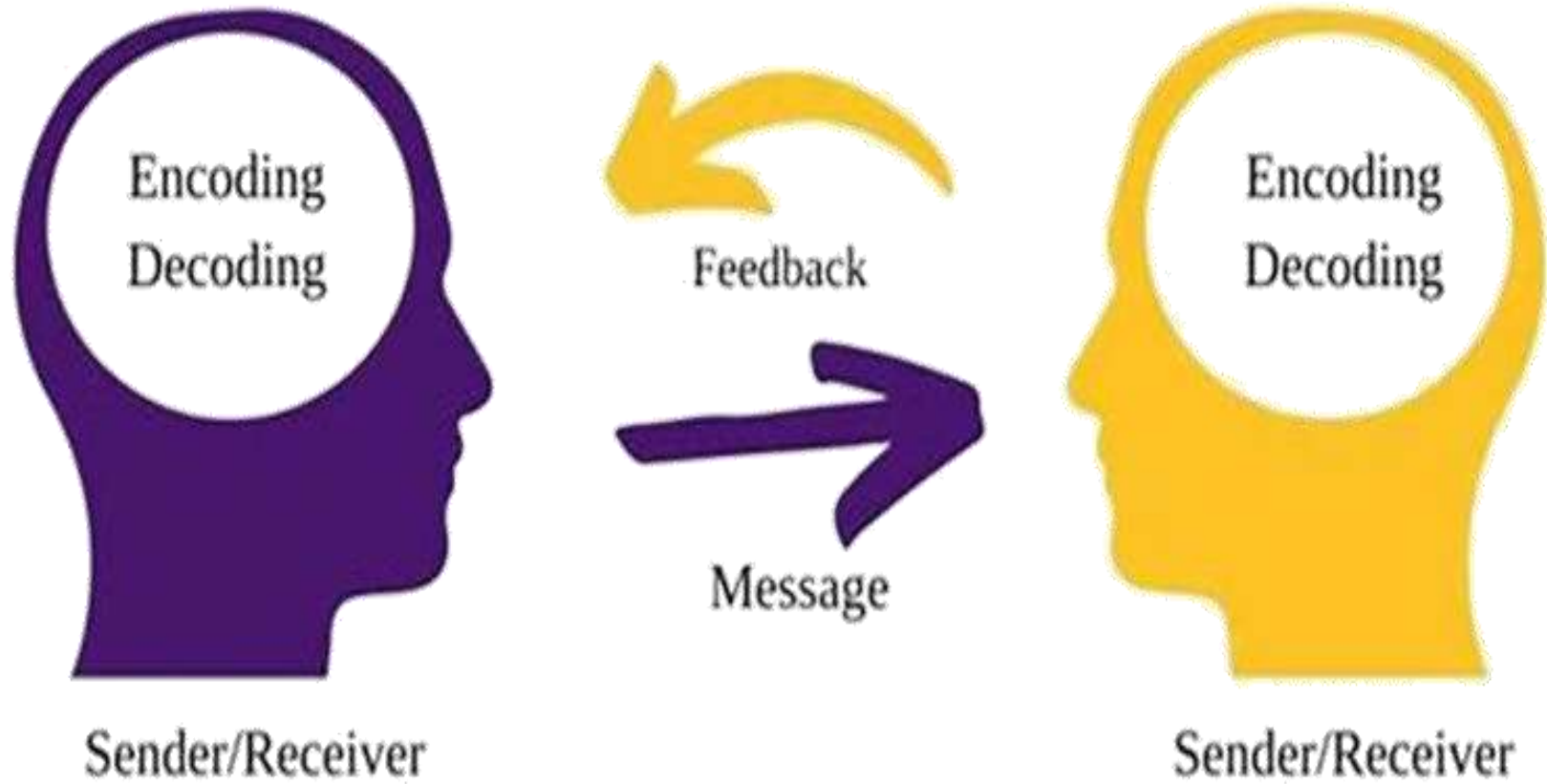
Relevance?

This session links to the following Learning Outcome:

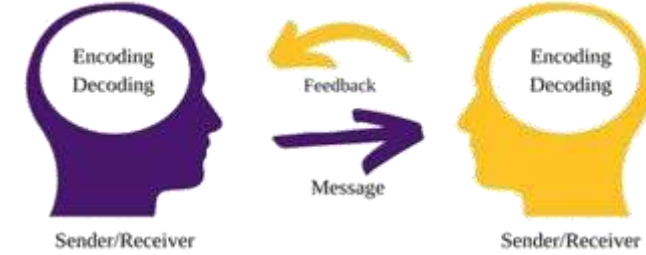
LO1- Demonstrate a knowledge of the core principles, theories and differing methods of communication and collaboration within a range of organisational contexts.



What is meant by interactive?



What is meant by interactive?



- The word Interactive is defined by- involving people or things influencing or having an effect on each other: *"we welcome your input and look forward to an interactive discussion"*
- Interactive communication in essence is a **two-way communication**.
- **Transactional communication** on the other hand, relates more to a two-way communication model, where the message becomes more complex as the conversation progresses.
- Both Interactive and Transactional communications relate to allowing a two-way flow of information where both sender and receiver can play both roles.
- Both Interactive and Transactional models acknowledge feedback, context, and the dynamic nature of communication.

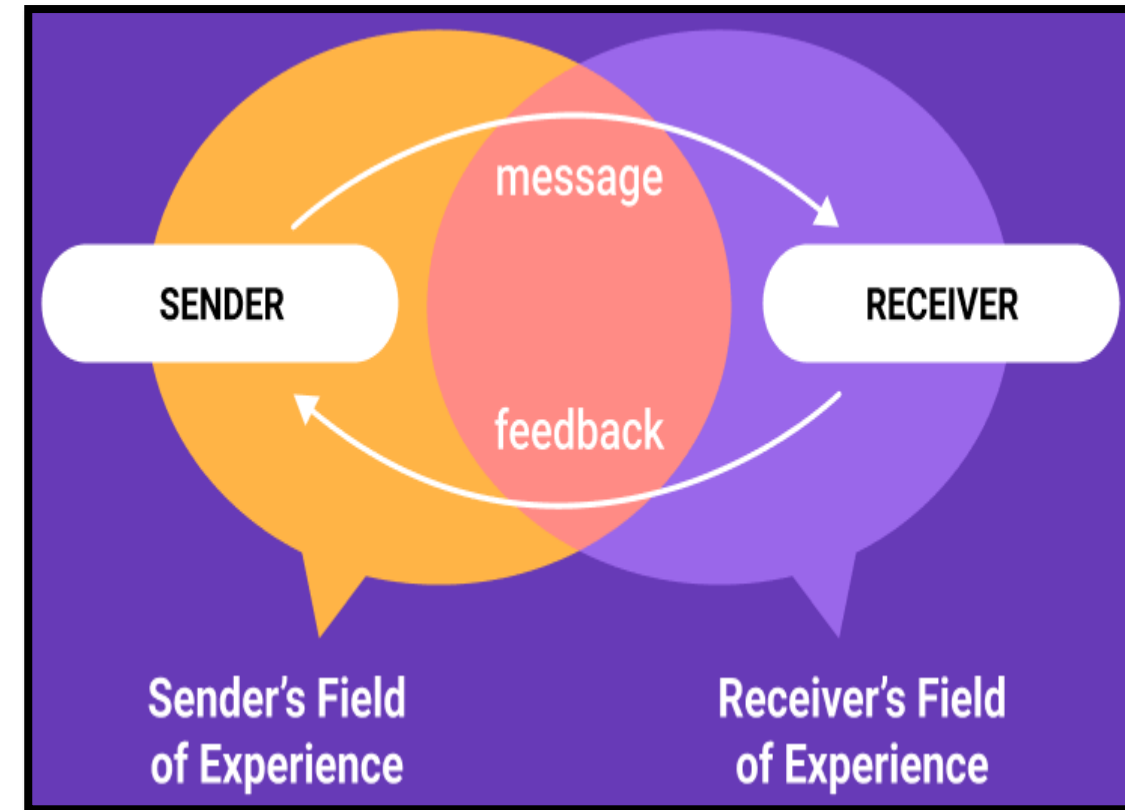
Interactive models of communication

The main elements of interactive models include the following:

- Sender
- Message
- Receiver
- Feedback
- Field of experience

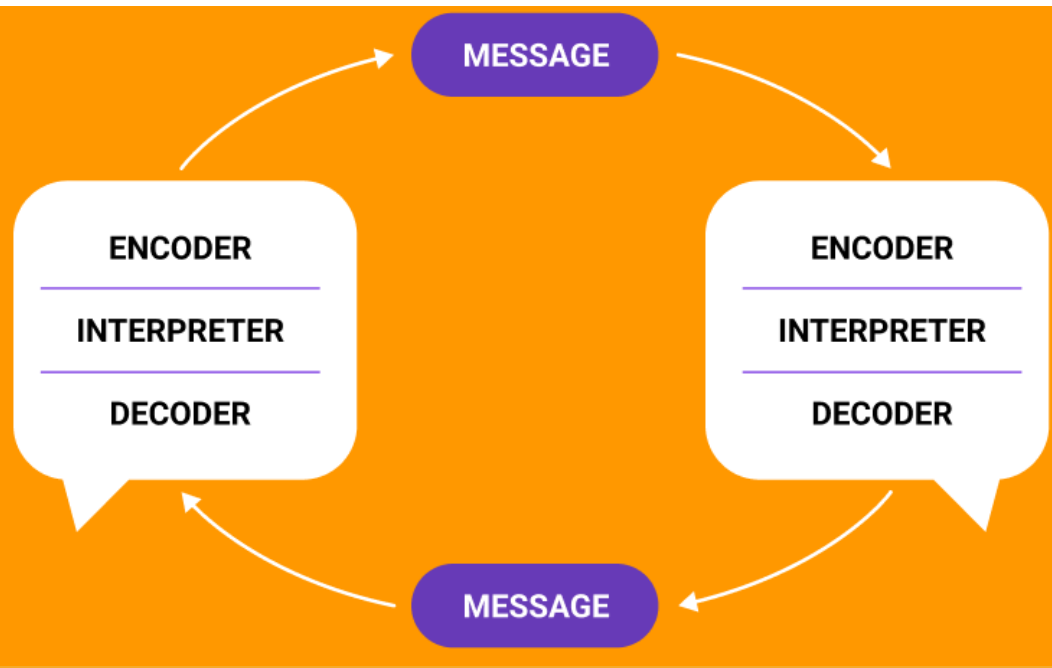
The field of experience represents a person's culture, past experiences, and personal history.

All these factors influence how the sender constructs a message, as well as how the receiver interprets it.



The Osgood-Schramm model

- An example of Interactive Communication models is the Osgood-Schramm model which was developed by Wilbur Schramm and Charles Osgood in the 1950s.
- It represents one of the first models to emphasise communication as a two-way process rather than a linear one.



Encoder

- The person who originates and sends the message

Decoder

- The person who receives and interprets the message

Interpreter

- The cognitive function that processes the message

Message

- The content being communicated

Medium

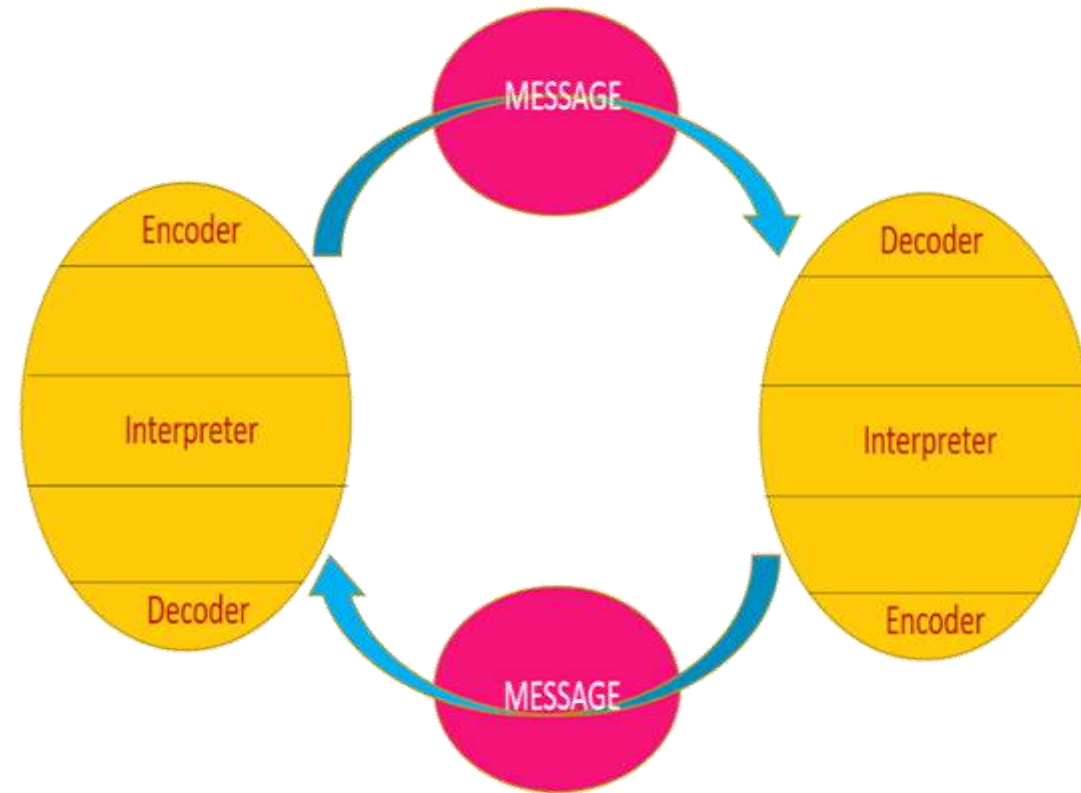
- The channel through which the message travels

Feedback

- The response from the receiver back to the sender

The Osgood-Schramm model of communication

- The Osgood-Schramm model is often seen as a circular model of communication, in which messages go in two directions between encoding and decoding.
- In this model, there is no difference between a sender and a receiver. Both parties are equally encoding and decoding the messages. The interpreter is the person trying to understand the message at that moment.



Use the Osgood-Schramm model of communication with someone in your class who you don't usually speak with

Introduce yourself and find out something new and exciting about your classmate.

You will need to provide feedback on your discussion to the group

The Osgood-Schramm model of communication

The Osgood-Schramm model was considered groundbreaking because it:

- Rejected earlier linear models (like Shannon-Weaver)
- Recognised the shared nature of communication between sender and receiver
- Acknowledged the importance of context and personal experience and how this plays a vital part
- Introduced the concept of feedback as an essential element in effective communication

Consider:

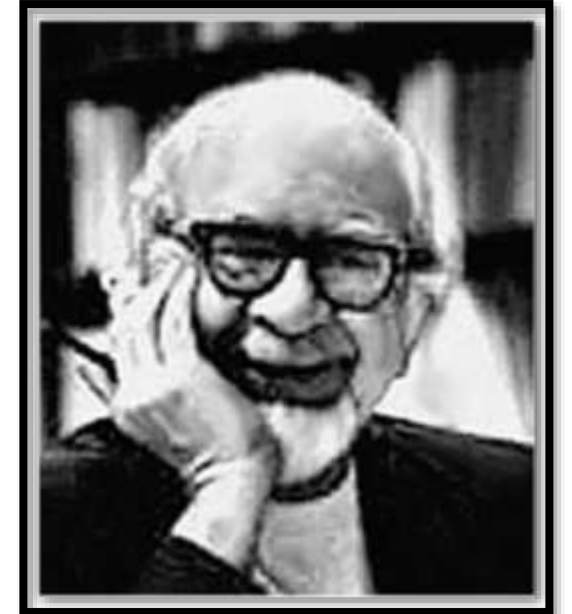
How is this model effective in modern day?

Does this model still apply in a digital age?

What are your views on this interactive theory?

The Westley and Maclean model of communication

- The Westley and Maclean communication model suggests that the communication process does not start with the source/sender, but rather with environmental factors.
- Developed by Bruce Westley and Malcolm MacLean in 1957. It builds upon linear models by introducing important concepts of feedback and acknowledging the complex nature of communication processes.
- This model also considers the object of the orientation (background, culture, and beliefs) of the sender and the receivers.
- The process of communication, according to this model, starts with environmental factors that influence the speaker — the culture or society the speaker lives in, whether the speaker is in a public or private space, etc.



What are the main elements of the Westley and Maclean communication model?

This model consists of 9 crucial components:

Environment (X1, X2, X3, etc.) – External stimuli or events that influence communication.

Source (A) – The person or entity initiating the communication by responding to stimuli.

Message (X') – The information being communicated, shaped by the source's interpretation.

Receiver (B) – The person or audience interpreting the message.

Gatekeeper (C) – An intermediary (e.g., editor, media outlet, manager) who filters or alters the message before it reaches the receiver.

Feedback (fBA and fAB) – The responses exchanged between sender and receiver, ensuring communication is dynamic rather than one-way.

WESTLEY AND MACLEAN'S MODEL OF COMMUNICATION



EXPLAINED IN 3 MINUTES

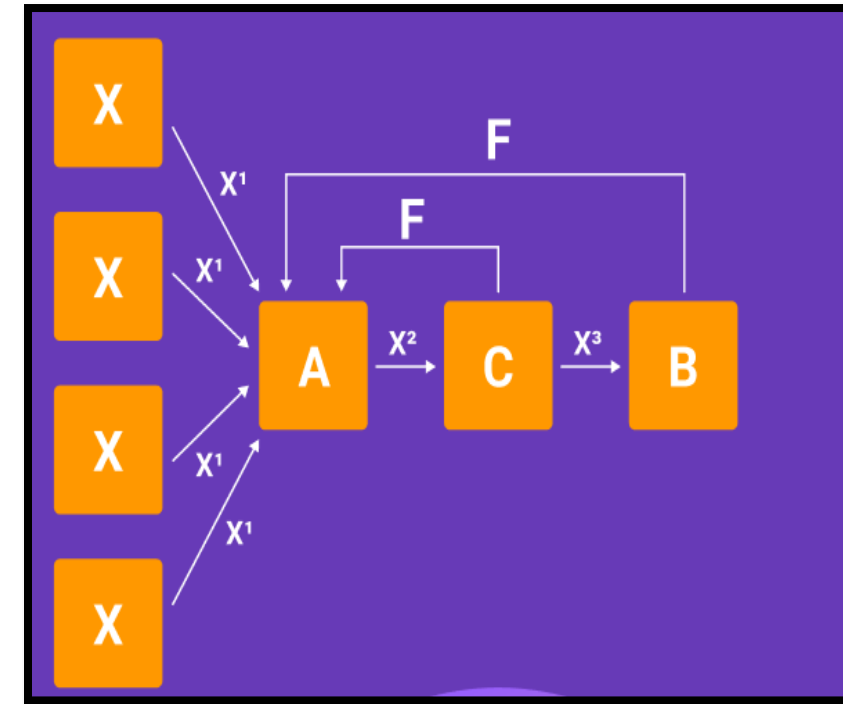
Main Features of this model

Circular Process: Unlike linear models, it highlights the continuous nature of communication between sender and receiver.

Feedback Loop: Essential for interaction and message refinement.

Gatekeeping Role: Recognises that messages may be filtered or modified before reaching the receiver, especially in mass communication.

Environmental Influence: Acknowledges how external events may influence communication.





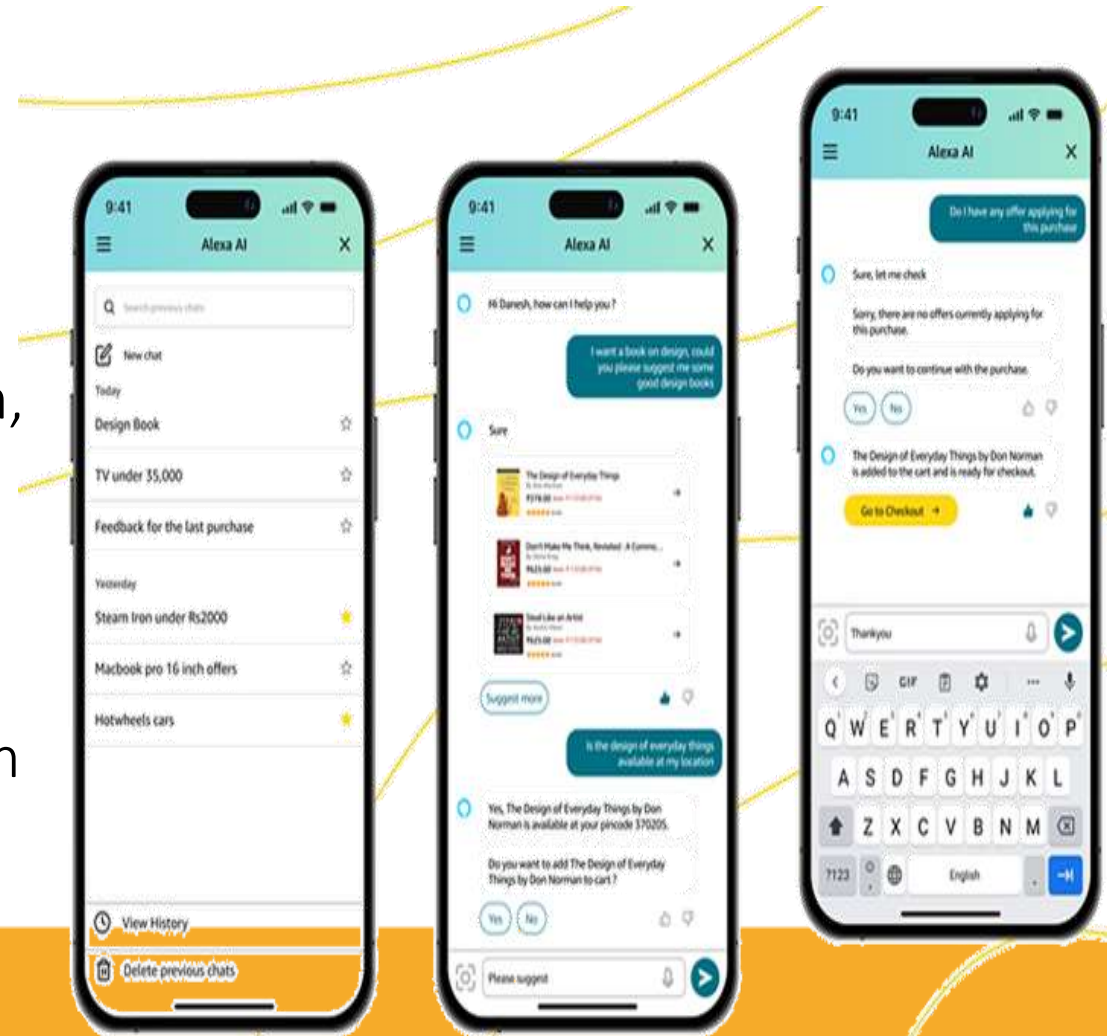
Explore the main elements of the Westley and Maclean communication model and provide the feedback.

What are the advantages and disadvantages of this model?

Debate these with your peers

Applying Interactive Communication Models in Business

- Many companies like Amazon will use AI chatbots for initial customer inquiries but transitions to human agents when deeper engagement is needed.
- The chatbot sends messages to the customer (encoding), and the customer responds with feedback. If an issue requires human intervention, a customer service representative joins the chat, engaging in a back-and-forth dialogue.
- This model ensures efficient customer service while allowing for personalised human interaction when necessary.



What other methods can you think of?

Task:

Scenario:

Microsoft, a global technology company, faced challenges in cross-functional collaboration, remote work efficiency, and customer engagement.

The company needed a communication model that facilitated real-time interaction, fostered collaboration, and improved decision-making across its global teams.

In groups you are asked to explore how Microsoft have implemented more interactive communications channels ie Microsoft Teams.

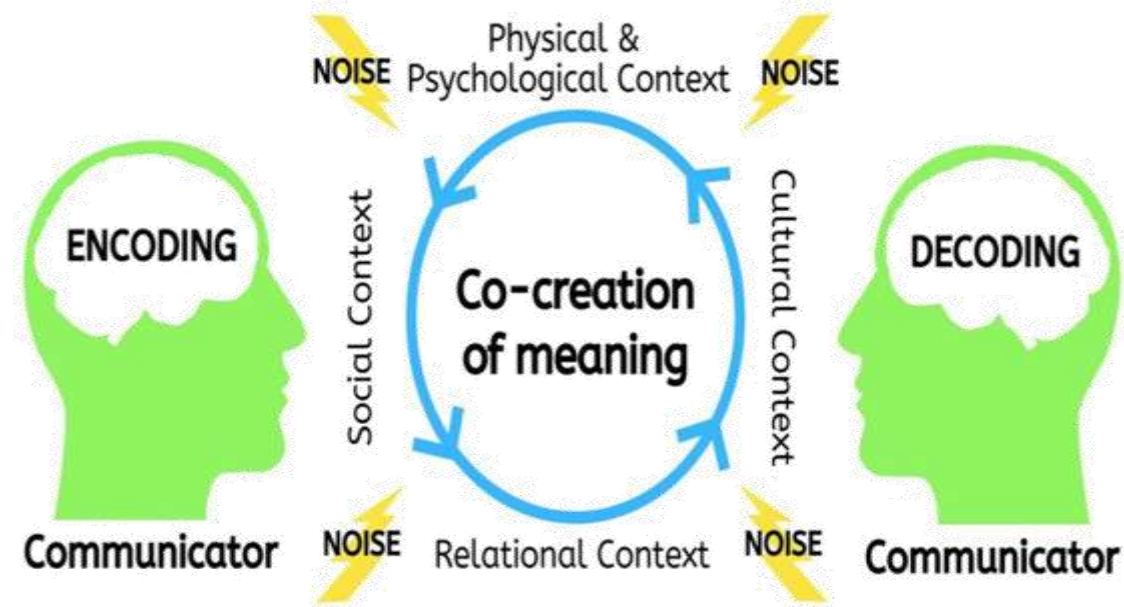
Consider:

- What are the benefits of Microsoft Teams on an organisational and employee perspective?
- How does this help with collaborative working and communication?
- Did the use of Microsoft Teams prove beneficial to the company?
- What challenges come with this?



Transactional Communication Models

- Transactional models are the most dynamic communication models, which introduce a new term for senders and receivers, known as “Communicators”.
- Transactional communication models view communication as a transaction, meaning that it is a cooperative process in which communicators co-create the process of communication together, thereby influencing its outcome and effectiveness.

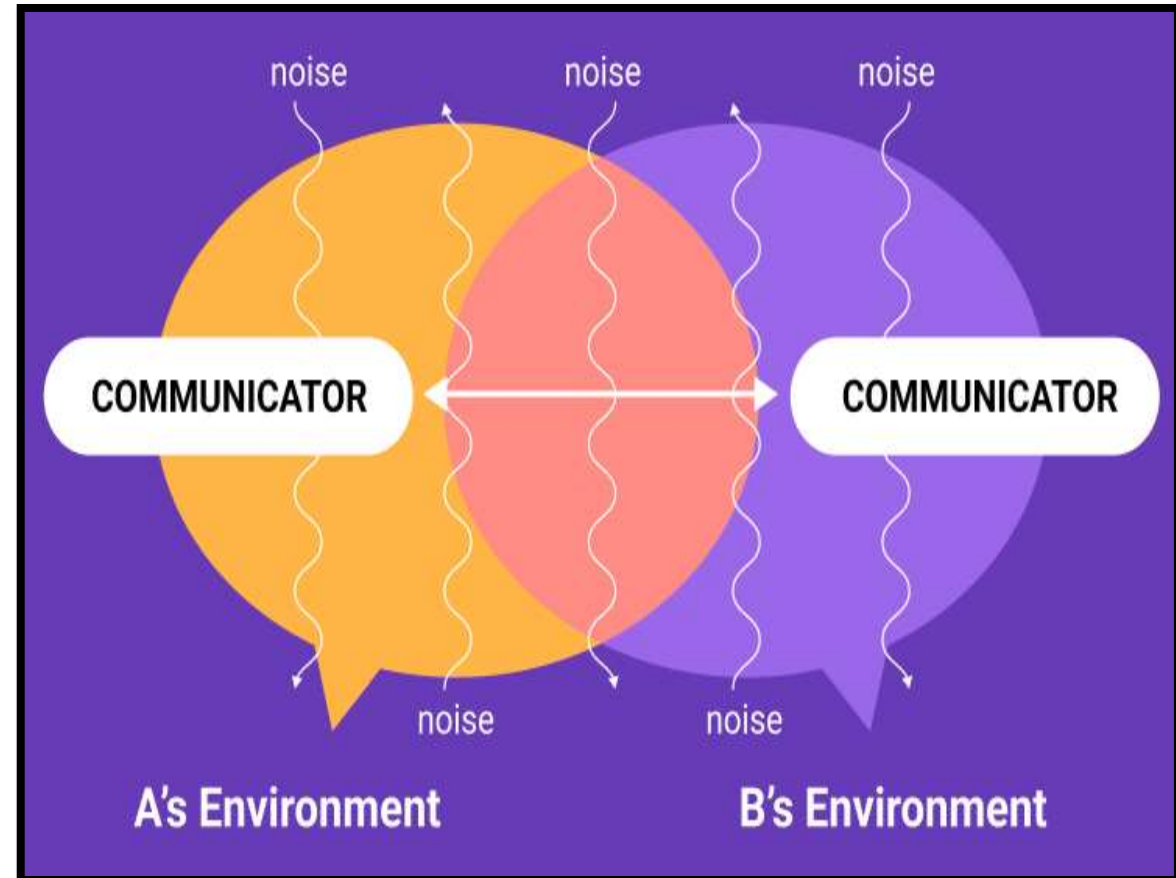


Transactional Communication Models

Transactional models show that we do not just exchange information during our interactions, but create relationships, form cross-cultural bonds, and shape our opinions.

Transactional models also introduced the roles of:

- Social
- Relational
- Cultural contexts.



Research Task:

You are tasked with exploring two popular Transactional Communication Models.

Case study 1:

Barnlund's transactional model of communication

Case Study 2:

Dance's Helical model of communication

Consider

- How does these models work?
- What are the main elements of these models?
- How do these models apply in modern day?

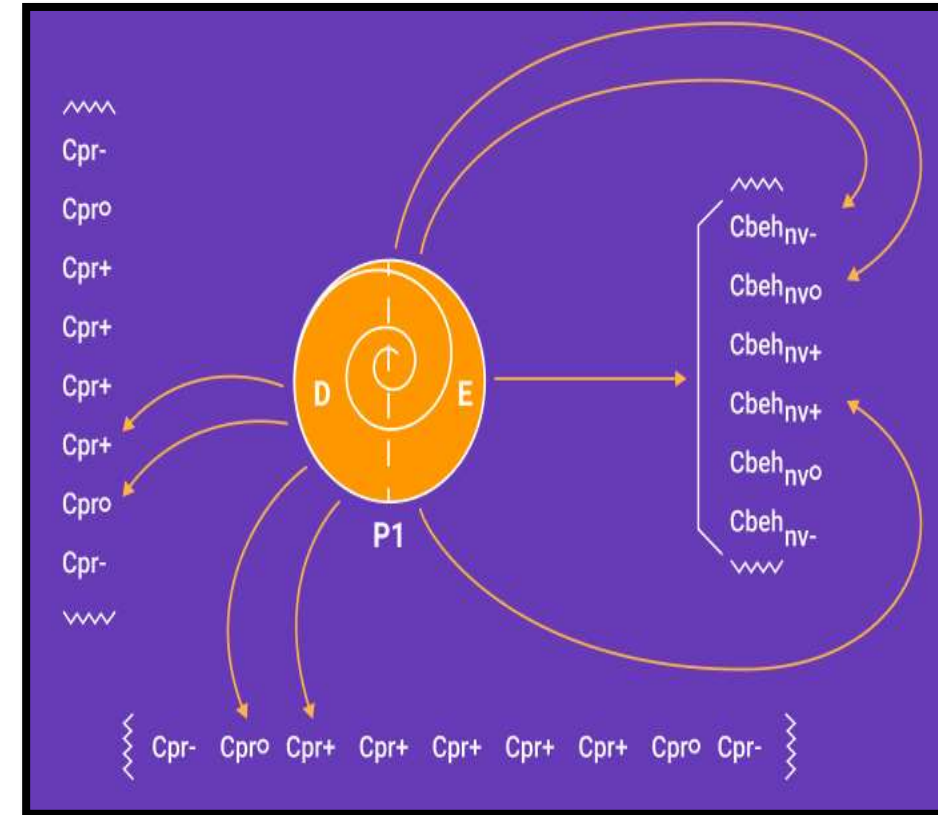
Report your findings with your peers

Review: Barnlund's transactional model of communication

Barnlund's Transactional Model of Communication is a dynamic that emphasises the simultaneous exchange of messages between communicators. The model highlights the continuous, reciprocal nature of communication.

Barnlund's transactional communication model illustrates the following main components of this communication model:

- Encoding,
- Decoding,
- Communicators,
- The message (including the cues, environment, and noise), and
- The channel.



Main takeaways of Barnlund's Model

- **Simultaneous Sending and Receiving** – Communication is a two-way process where both participants act as senders and receivers at the same time.
- **Multidimensional Messages** – Messages are conveyed through multiple channels, including verbal and nonverbal cues (e.g., facial expressions, gestures, tone of voice).
- **Context Dependency** – Communication is influenced by the psychological, relational, social, and cultural context in which it occurs.
- **Noise and Feedback** – Barriers (noise) can distort communication, while feedback helps participants adjust their messages for clarity.
- **Cues and Codes** – People interpret messages using public cues (shared symbols, language), private cues (personal thoughts and emotions), and behavioral cues (body language, facial expressions).
- **Continuous Process** – Communication does not have a clear beginning or end but flows continuously as participants react and respond.

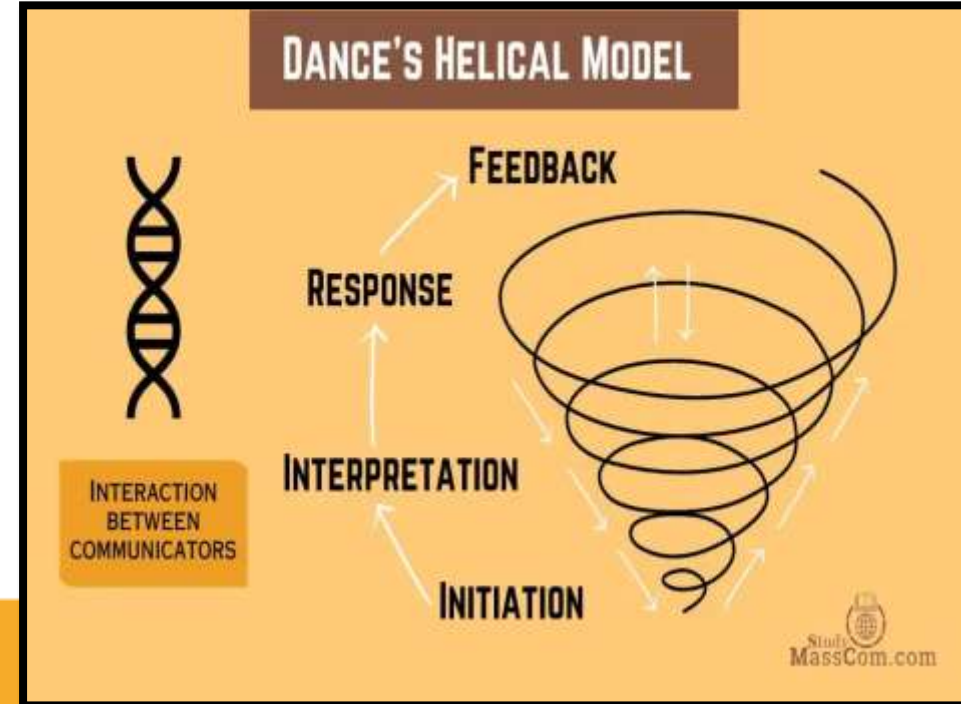
Review: Dance's Helical Model of Communication

- Dance's Helical Model of Communication (1967) presents communication as a continuous, evolving, and cyclical process.
- Unlike linear, it emphasises how communication expands over time, much like a growing helix (spiral).



Main points of Dance's Helical Model of Communication

- **Evolutionary Process** – Communication is not static; it builds upon past interactions and improves over time as individuals gain experience.
- **Circular and Expanding** – Like a helix, communication moves forward while looping back, meaning past experiences influence future communication.
- **No Clear Beginning or End** – Unlike linear models, there is no single starting point; communication starts from birth and develops through accumulated experiences.
- **Memory and Learning** – Previous interactions shape how we communicate in the future, making it a learning-driven process.
- **Gradual Improvement** – Effective communication takes time, experience, and feedback, leading to better clarity and understanding over time.



Case Study: Transactional Communication Model at Amazon

Scenario: Amazon relies on fast, efficient, and dynamic communication to manage its vast logistics network, customer service operations, and internal decision-making. The company operates in a high-speed environment where immediate feedback and real-time exchanges are crucial.

Challenge

- Amazon needed an efficient communication system to handle millions of customer service interactions daily.
- Coordination between warehouses, delivery partners, and customer support required seamless, two-way communication.
- Internal teams needed a structured approach to quickly make decisions and resolve issues in real time.

Using your knowledge on communication models, identify how you can meet Amazon's needs by implementing different communication models and methods

Modern Communication Models/Methods?

All these communication models demonstrate good understanding of communication methods, but how do these apply in a modern-day digital age?

Modern Communications Operating Model

The Government Communication Service (GCS) published the 'Modern Communications Operating Model: A blueprint for government communication'.

The model sets out the fundamental disciplines and practices for effective public service communications.

Read the article to establish a better understanding of this modern communication model.



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Modern Communication Operation Model

- The Modern Communications Operating Model is a comprehensive framework developed by the Government Communication Service (GCS) to guide government communicators in delivering effective and efficient public service communications.
- This model was launched in July 2023, and consolidates essential policies, guidance, and tools into a user-friendly resource accessible to all communication professionals across government departments and Arm's-Length Bodies (ALBs).

Research the framework and answer the following:

1. What are the key components of the Modern Communications Operating Model, and how do they contribute to effective communication within government organisations?
2. How has the adoption of this model influenced the effectiveness of government communication?
3. What potential future developments or revisions could further improve this model? How might emerging technologies (e.g., AI, data analytics) shape its evolution?



Session Takeaways:

- Both interactive and transactional communication models are essential in business.
- Interactive communication is particularly useful for structured digital interactions and remote teamwork, while the transactional model is vital for dynamic, real-time interactions like negotiations and leadership engagement.
- Successful companies integrate both models to enhance communication effectiveness, employee collaboration, and customer satisfaction.

Session Recap:

Have we:

- Investigated both interactive and transactional models of communication
- Understood contemporary models and the use of digital platforms and communication
- Explored how technology is changing the way we communicate, work and behave.



Thank you.

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